



China consumer

Global Markets Research

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EQUITY: CONSUMER RELATED

Softened performance for the Nanjing-based mall

Weakened sales performance and foot traffic during Jul-Aug; divergent performances across major luxury brands

We hosted a channel check call (7 September) with an expert with deep knowledge of China's high-end consumption trends, who provided observations on a leading luxury shopping mall, located in Nanjing of Jiangsu Province. Our key takeaways from the call are summarized below:

Sales momentum further softened in 3Q26

According to the expert, the shopping mall's sales performance and foot traffic further weakened during Jul-Aug in 3Q26 from 2Q26 (key sales periods and luxury brands' discounts supported the performance), with slight y-y declines in both sales and foot traffic. The expert believes that the softened performance during Jul-Aug in 3Q26 was mainly due to 1) no major shopping festivals/promotional events occurring during Jul-Aug; 2) unfavourable weather, which discouraged people from traveling; and 3) overseas traveling, particularly in Japan, which diverted a portion of foot traffic.

The expert also noted that in an unstable external environment (such as changes in tax policies), some consumption habits of VICs are shifting: hedonic spending is becoming more restrained, while experience-related consumptions is strengthening. In the long term, the new middle class will see the most significant weakening in luxury consumption, with both spending amounts and frequency dropping notably, according to the expert.

Mixed performance by major brands

The expert mentioned that the overall sales of luxury segment (including global luxury brands and gold & jewelry segment) declined by a high-single-digit% (HSD%) y-y during Jul-Aug in 3Q26, though sales and foot traffic have marginal rebounded since the Qixi Festival in late August. Based on the expert's comments, there were divergent sales performances across major brands in the luxury segment.

- Gold & jewelry brands: according to the expert, global leading jewelry brands such as Van Cleef & Arpels [owned by Richemont (CFR SW, Not rated)] continued its strong sales momentum with double-digit% y-y same-store-sales growth (SSSG) during Jul-Aug in 3Q26, and Cartier (owned by Richemont) also showed robust sales momentum, with SSSG increasing by low-teens% y-y during Jul-Aug 2026, from the y-y decline in SSSG in 2Q26. The expert also expects Van Cleef & Arpels and Cartier will continue its growth momentum in 4Q26E, with high-teens%/double-digit% y-y SSSG, respectively. However, the sales of Bulgari [owned by LVMH (MC FP, Not rated)] and Tiffany (owned by LVMH) remained sluggish during Jul-Aug 2026 and the downtrend is expected to continue in 4Q26E, according to the expert. For the domestic premium jewelry brand Laopu Gold (6181 HK, Buy), the expert mentioned that since the retreat in gold prices in 2Q26, Laopu has been facing significant growth pressure; however, this trend showed signs of improvement in August, particularly during the Qixi Festival at the end of the month, which brought a recovery in both sales and foot traffic for Laopu.
- Global fashion luxury brands: based on the expert's observation, Chanel (unlisted) continued its strong sales momentum with over 10% y-y growth during Jul-Aug in 3Q26; Hermès (RMS FP, Not rated) and Louis Vuitton (owned by LVMH) maintained steady sales momentum with low to mid-single-digit% y-y growth; and Dior (owned by LVMH) has continued to see clear signs of a recovery. However, Gucci's [owned by Kering (KER FP, Not rated)] downtrend continued during Jul-Aug 2026, according to the expert.

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Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Laopu Gold	6181 HK	HKD 393.60	08-Sep-2026	Buy	N/A	

Laopu Gold (6181 HK)

HKD 393.60 (08-Sep-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our target price of HKD905 is based on 20x FY26F P/E, consistent with Laopu's average F12M P/E of 20.3x since its listing in June 2024. The benchmark index for the company is the Hang Seng Index.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Key downside risks include: 1) any significant weakening of gold price, 2) higher-than-expected fashion risk, 3) weaker-than-expected macro environment.

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